16.3% of 2025–2034 mining investment is in study-stage projects with no identified SEIA filing

US$17,043m across 7 projects, all at study stage · SEA data to 25-08-2026

Cumulative EIA approval

31.7% at 24 months · n=124
51.7% at 36 months
50% at ~33 months

EIAs ≥US$100m approved at 24 months

39.6% (95% CI 27.6–52.0) · n=81

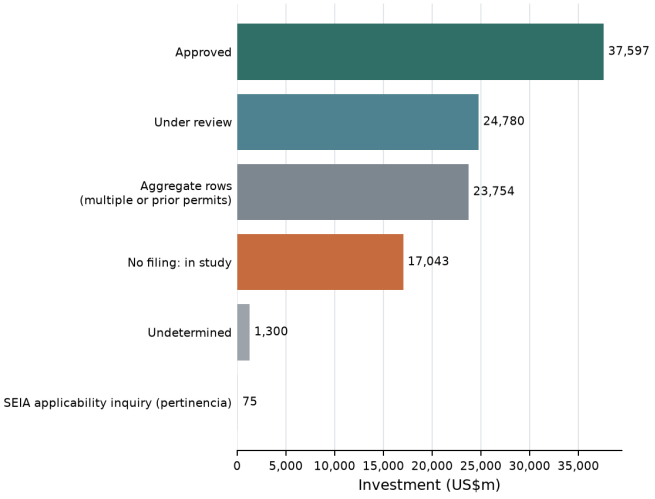
Under review at SEA cut-off

US$24,780m · 15 projects

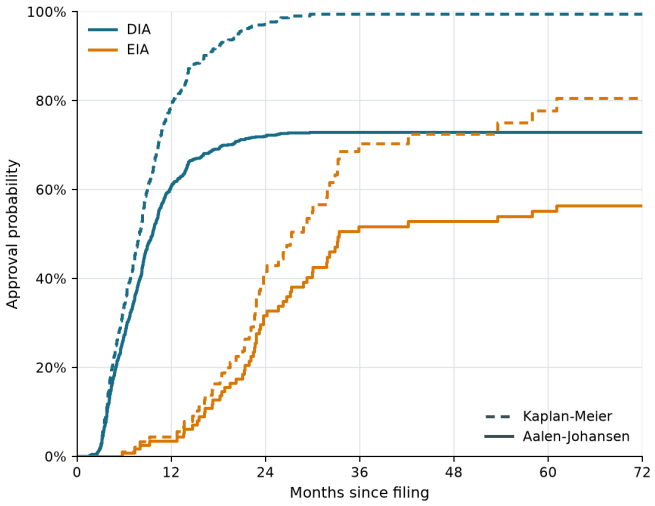
Favourable RCA

US$37,597m · 36.0% of portfolio

2025–2034 portfolio by SEIA status (US$m)



Ignoring withdrawals, rejections and early terminations (Kaplan–Meier) overstates approval



Implications for contractors

- As of the cut-off, these ~US$17,000m have no SEIA filing on record. If they require an EIA, only 31.7% of mining EIAs are approved 24 months after filing.
- For EIAs ≥US$100m, we estimate 39.6% approved at 24 months (95% CI 27.6–52.0%): permit schedules should include contingency beyond Cochilco's commissioning dates.
- Separately, 4 aggregate rows in execution (US$23,754m) bundle several projects with multiple or prior permits; they are not assigned a unique filing and are excluded from the headline.

Method and scope

Sources: Cochilco, 2025–2034 Mining Investment Project Portfolio (Annex C, Dec-2025). SEA: downloaded 30-09-2026; latest record 25-08-2026.
Population: 995 admitted mining filings entered between 2011 and 2026; excludes sand-and-gravel (áridos) filings. Kaplan–Meier and Aalen–Johansen; months = days/30.44.
Portfolio: one principal filing per project; modifications do not count as a match. Times: each filing, including re-entries.
All 59 projects were reviewed one by one against SEA. Headline sensitivity: 8.6% excluding the largest judgment-call project; 40.3% adding aggregate rows and the undetermined case.
Favourable RCA includes 1 project (US$4,851m) whose valid RCA has an update under review.
Figures are reproducible from the repository's code and data and checked by automated tests.